

LEGISLATIVE POLICY BRIEF

Protected Planning Time for Florida Teachers

A statutory floor of 90 minutes of duty-free planning time per day, met by whatever schedule a district already runs, as the retention half of Florida's teacher compensation strategy.

PREPARED FOR

Members of the Florida Legislature and the Executive Office of the Governor

For consideration ahead of the 2027 Regular Session (convening March 2, 2027)

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I. Summary

Since 2020 Florida has invested more than a billion dollars a year in the Teacher Salary Increase Allocation, and the FY 2026-27 General Appropriations Act added \$201 million directed at teachers with ten or more years of experience, capped at \$3,000 per teacher. The strategy has moved starting pay to 19th in the nation. It has not moved average pay, which ranks 50th of 51 at \$56,663 against a national average of \$74,495, and it has not closed the vacancy gap. The Florida Education Association counted 3,157 advertised instructional vacancies in August 2026, several hundred more than a year earlier.

Pay is what brings a teacher to the contract. The workday is what decides whether they sign the next one. Florida law requires every district to make provision for planning time and sets no minimum. In practice most secondary teachers on a seven-period day receive one planning period of about 50 minutes, which leaves under nine minutes of in-school preparation for each of the six classes they teach. The rest of the work goes home. RAND's 2025 State of the American Teacher survey puts the average teacher week at 49 hours, about 10 of them uncompensated, and finds that hours outside the contract day rank with pay among the top sources of stress.

This brief proposes the lever Florida has never pulled: a statutory floor of 90 minutes of duty-free planning time per day, 450 minutes per week, for every full-time classroom teacher. That is the planning time a teacher on an A/B block schedule already receives, three classes taught and one block to plan on both days. The floor does not prescribe a schedule. A seven-period district meets it with a second planning period. A six-period district meets it with its one period plus the contracted duty-free time most of its teachers already spend on campus after the student day. A block district already meets it. The floor is codified at current practice in year one so no district loses ground, and reaches 90 minutes in year three.

50th

Florida's rank of 51 in average teacher pay, 2024-25 (NEA, April 2026)

3,157

Advertised instructional vacancies statewide, August 2026 (FEA)

90 min

Daily duty-free planning floor proposed, equal to one block on an A/B schedule

10 hrs

Average uncompensated hours per week beyond contract (RAND, 2025)

What the proposal does

- Amends s. 1012.22(1)(h), F.S., to establish Florida's first statutory minimum for duty-free planning time: 250 minutes per week in 2027-28, rising to 450 minutes per week (90 minutes per day) in 2029-30, with a State Board waiver process.
- Defines duty-free in statute, so that planning periods and contracted after-school time consumed by substitute coverage, mandatory meetings, and assigned duties no longer count toward the floor.

- Leaves the schedule to the district. Seven-period, six-period, A/B block, and 4x4 block schedules each meet the floor in a different way, and the brief compares the cost and trade-offs of each.
- Funds one-time technical assistance and transition grants through the Department of Education, and requires annual reporting of planning minutes delivered, minutes lost to coverage, and retention by district against a published statewide target.

Recommendation

File the amendment to s. 1012.22, F.S., with a nonrecurring appropriation of about \$30 million for transition support in FY 2027-28, and direct the Department of Education to report baseline planning minutes by district and schedule type before the 2028 Regular Session. Section VIII sets out the sequencing.

II. Present Situation

A. Florida's compensation strategy and its limit

The Teacher Salary Increase Allocation within the Florida Education Finance Program has raised the minimum base salary every year since 2020. The National Education Association's April 2026 Rankings and Estimates report shows the result: Florida's average starting salary of \$49,435 ranks 19th in the nation, above the national average of \$48,112. Average salary across all teachers is \$56,663, 50th of the 50 states and the District of Columbia, and NEA estimates Florida's average salary has lost 12.4 percent of its purchasing power over ten years.

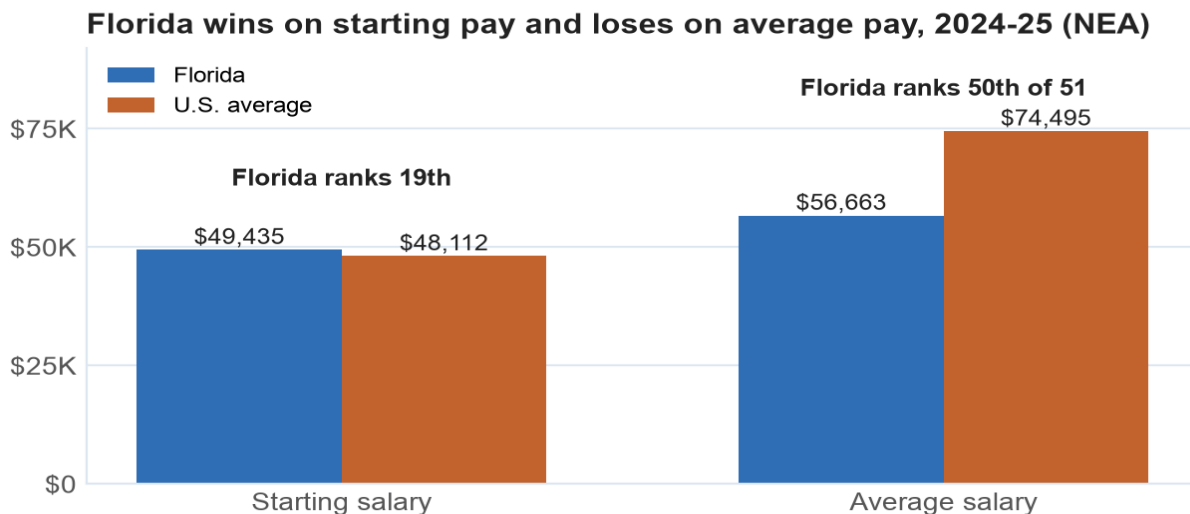


Figure 1. Florida and U.S. average teacher salaries, 2024-25. Source: National Education Association, Rankings and Estimates, April 2026.

The FY 2026-27 General Appropriations Act (HB 5001E, chapter 2026-232) added \$201 million for teachers with ten or more years of experience, capped at \$3,000 per teacher and distributed through districts. The Legislature's intent, stated during budget negotiations, was to keep veteran

teachers from leaving. That is the right target. This brief proposes a second instrument aimed at the same target.

B. Vacancies

The Florida Education Association counts vacancies posted on district websites each August and January.

Count date	Instructional vacancies	Support staff vacancies	Total
August 2024	5,007	4,835	9,842
August 2025	2,260	2,523	5,489
August 2026	3,157	about 2,380	about 5,536

Source: Florida Education Association press releases, August 2024, August 2025, and August 2026; WLRN, August 10, 2026. FEA attributes part of the 2025 decline to districts eliminating positions rather than filling them.

Two features of the vacancy data matter for policy design. First, the count rose again in 2026 after a year of pay increases, which is consistent with the research finding that pay alone does not fix retention. Second, FEA reported in 2024 that about 31 percent of Florida teachers had four or fewer years of experience. Florida is short on teachers and shorter still on teachers who stay long enough to become experienced.

C. Current law: a requirement with no floor

Section 1012.22(1)(h), F.S., provides that the district school board "shall adopt rules to make provisions for teachers to have time for lunch, professional planning, and professional learning when they will not be directly responsible for the children if some adult supervision is furnished." Section 1001.42(4)(k), F.S., provides that a board may adopt rules for planning time in accordance with chapter 1012. No section of chapter 1012, and no State Board of Education rule in the 6A series, sets a minimum number of minutes. Planning time in Florida is set entirely by local board policy and collective bargaining.

The result is a patchwork. Three of the state's largest districts illustrate the typical range:

District (agreement)	Elementary	Secondary
Hillsborough (2023-26)	2.5 hours per week, about 30 minutes a day, plus 35 minutes before or after the student day	One full period per day

District (agreement)	Elementary	Secondary
Duval (2025-27)	40 minutes before school plus two resource periods per week of at least 45 minutes	One full period daily in seven-period schools; four 90-minute periods per week in A/B block schools
Orange (2024-27)	60 minutes average per day, 45 contiguous	One period or 50 minutes, whichever is less

Source: collective bargaining agreements published by the Hillsborough Classroom Teachers Association, Duval Teachers United, and the Orange County Classroom Teachers Association.

One period in a seven-period day is the Florida norm for secondary teachers. Many agreements also permit that period to be taken for substitute coverage, sometimes with a stipend and sometimes without, and many require teachers to remain on campus for a set period after the student day that is routinely filled with meetings and duties. A planning period that is routinely reassigned is not planning time.

D. The arithmetic of one period

A secondary teacher with one 50-minute period and six sections has under nine minutes of in-school preparation per section per day. Grading one set of essays can take two hours. The work does not vanish when the bell rings. It moves to the evening and becomes uncompensated time, and that time is what convinces a good teacher the job cannot be sustained.

The national data describe the same pattern. RAND's 2025 State of the American Teacher survey found teachers working an average of 49 hours per week, about 10 of them beyond contract, with 16 percent intending to leave the profession. RAND's 2026 edition reports intent-to-leave at 18 percent. The OECD's 2024 Teaching and Learning International Survey found U.S. lower-secondary teachers working more than 45 hours a week against an OECD average near 40, with 30 percent reporting high stress against an OECD average of 19 percent. American teachers teach more hours and prepare in fewer than nearly all of their peers abroad.

E. Other states set a floor. Florida does not.

State	Authority	Minimum
Texas	Education Code s. 21.404	450 minutes per two weeks, in blocks of at least 45 minutes
Tennessee	Code s. 49-1-302	At least 150 minutes per week, duty-free and individual
Georgia	Code s. 20-2-218; Rule 160-5-1-.02	Daily planning period; at least 30 minutes a day or 150 minutes a week

State	Authority	Minimum
North Carolina	General Statutes s. 115C-301.1	Goal of at least 300 minutes per week, to the extent resources allow
Virginia	Code s. 22.1-291.1; Virginia Beach Regulation 4-60.1	Elementary teachers average at least 30 minutes a day by statute; large districts guarantee 225 to 250 minutes per week by regulation
Florida	s. 1012.22(1)(h), F.S.	None. Districts must "make provisions" for planning time

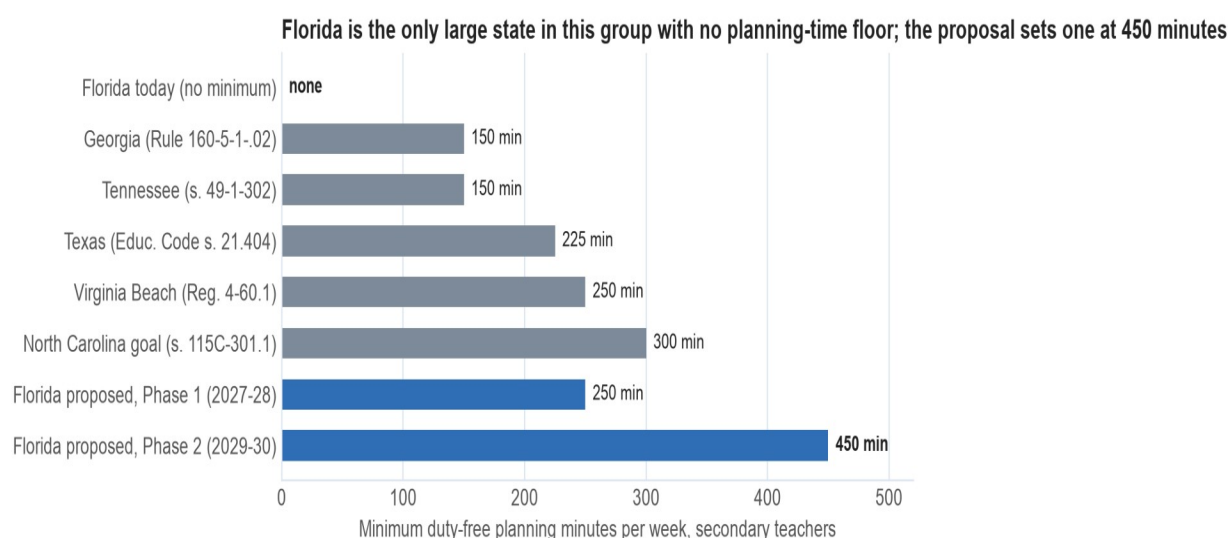


Figure 2. Minimum weekly duty-free planning minutes for secondary teachers set by statute or regulation, with the proposed Florida floor. North Carolina's figure is a statutory goal, not a mandate. Virginia's statute covers elementary teachers; the Virginia Beach regulation is shown for secondary.

Florida already sets statewide floors on the parts of the workday it considers essential: instructional hours, the 180-day year, and class size. Planning time is the one input to instruction the state has left undefined.

III. Evidence That Time Retains Teachers

A. Working conditions predict turnover, and turnover is expensive

The Learning Policy Institute's March 2026 analysis found that teachers reporting high job satisfaction left at a rate of 8.0 percent, against 22.0 percent for teachers reporting low satisfaction. The Institute's 2024 cost estimates put the replacement cost of a single teacher at \$11,860 in a small district, \$16,450 in a medium district, and \$24,930 in a large one. Six Florida districts rank among the largest in the country, so the large-district figure applies to most Florida teachers. Every

thousand teachers a large Florida district replaces costs it on the order of \$25 million in recruitment, hiring, and training, before any loss of instructional quality.

B. A network that doubled planning time and kept its teachers

Alliance College-Ready Public Schools, a network of 25 public charter schools in Los Angeles, piloted a schedule in three schools that nearly doubled teacher planning time. Students take seven periods on an alternating-day block. Each teacher teaches five of the seven and holds two planning blocks a day. Supervisory duties were reassigned. No new appropriation was required; the change was made by reallocating existing staff time. Network-wide retention rose from 87 percent in 2022-23 to 91 percent in 2024-25, 91 percent of teachers reported more time to reflect on student data, and the network is expanding the model to 11 of its 25 schools by 2027-28 (Education Week, May 2026; Education Resource Strategies case study, February 2026).

The relevance to Florida is the teaching load, not the bell schedule. Five classes taught out of seven is what produced the planning time and the retention gain. Duval County's current agreement already provides four 90-minute planning periods a week in its A/B block schools, which shows the same amount of planning time operating inside Florida law and Florida budgets today. The question is whether the state will make that amount the floor for every schedule.

C. Two states, two schedules: my own comparison

I taught business education for two years in Loudoun County, Virginia, on an A/B block schedule. Four 90-minute periods a day, alternating days. I taught three of the four and held the fourth as a planning block, on A days and B days alike. I moved to Florida in the summer of 2026 and have since interviewed teachers in several districts about their schedules. The comparison below is drawn from that experience and from the Florida agreements cited above. Virginia's statewide norms are documented in Code s. 22.1-291.1 and in Virginia Beach Regulation 4-60.1, which guarantees 250 planning minutes per week to secondary teachers.

Measure	My Loudoun County schedule (A/B block)	Typical Florida seven-period schedule
Duty-free planning time per day	One 90-minute block	One period, about 50 minutes
Sections to prepare for in that time	3	6
In-school preparation per section	About 30 minutes	Under 9 minutes
Grading and preparation taken home	Little	Hours, most nights
After-school hours	Rarely	Most nights

The variable in that table is the schedule. Same subject, same effort, same student load, and a different answer to whether the grading goes home. In Loudoun I almost never stayed after school. The Florida teachers I have spoken with stay late most nights, because one period cannot hold the work of six classes. Offered a modest raise noticed twice a month or two hours of every evening returned, a large share of experienced teachers will take the time.

IV. Effect of Proposed Changes

A. Establish a statutory floor, phased in

Amend s. 1012.22(1)(h), F.S., to require that each full-time classroom teacher receive duty-free planning time of not less than the following, measured over the instructional week:

Phase	Secondary (grades 6 to 12)	Elementary (grades K to 5)
Phase 1: 2027-28 school year	250 minutes per week	225 minutes per week
Phase 2: 2029-30 school year	450 minutes per week (90 minutes per day)	300 minutes per week (60 minutes per day)

Phase 1 codifies what the large districts already provide, so it establishes the floor without cost and identifies the districts below it. Phase 2 is the planning time an A/B block teacher already holds: one 90-minute block on every teaching day. The two-year gap gives districts two bargaining cycles and two master-schedule cycles to get there. The State Board of Education may grant a waiver of up to two years to a district that documents a schedule constraint and files a plan.

B. How each schedule meets 90 minutes a day

The floor is written in minutes, not periods, so that it applies to every schedule in the state. A district keeps its schedule and meets the floor the way that schedule allows:

Schedule	How the floor is met	What changes for the teacher
Seven-period day (most Florida high schools)	Two planning periods of about 50 minutes each. Teaching load falls from six of seven periods to five of seven, the load Alliance used	One class fewer to prepare for; in-school preparation per section rises from under 9 minutes to about 20
Six-period day	One planning period of 50 to 60 minutes plus the contracted duty-free time after the student day. Most six-period contracts already require teachers to remain 35 to 60 minutes after dismissal; the floor is met by making that time duty-free rather than by adding it	No change to teaching load. Meetings and duties move out of the after-school block or are compensated separately

Schedule	How the floor is met	What changes for the teacher
A/B block (four 90-minute periods, alternating days)	One planning block each day, three classes taught. This is the schedule the floor is calibrated to	None. Already compliant, as Duval's block schools show
4x4 semester block (four 90-minute periods, courses change at semester)	One planning block each day, three classes taught	None. Already compliant

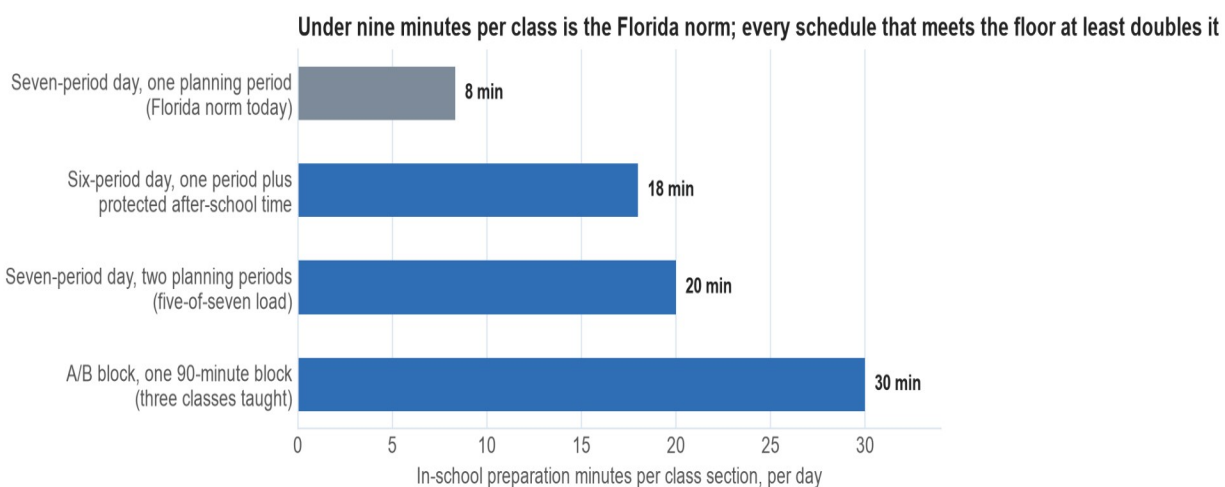


Figure 3. In-school preparation minutes per class section per day under each schedule, computed from planning minutes divided by sections taught. Six-period figure assumes a 50-minute period plus 40 minutes of protected after-school time.

C. The schedules compared

The brief does not recommend a schedule. It recommends a floor and shows what each schedule costs to meet it, so a district and its bargaining unit can choose with the trade-offs in front of them.

Schedule	Benefits	Drawbacks
Seven-period day, two planning periods	Widest course access for students; no change to the student day or to class length; the familiar schedule for most Florida families	Highest cost. One class fewer per teacher means one-sixth more sections to cover, so a district either hires, redesigns, or trims elective sections. Planning time comes in two 50-minute pieces rather than one block

Schedule	Benefits	Drawbacks
Six-period day plus contracted after-school time	Lowest cost; the time already exists in most contracts. Teaching load unchanged	Fewer course slots for students than seven periods. The after-school block is the first thing meetings consume, so the duty-free definition and the reporting requirement carry the whole design
A/B block	Cost-neutral: same teachers, same class sizes, 90 uninterrupted minutes. Fewer transitions and less passing time. Teachers see half their students each day and prepare for three classes	Alternating days mean an absent student misses two days of a course. Longer periods require different lesson design and teacher retraining. Fewer daily contacts for students who need routine
4x4 semester block	Three classes at a time for both teacher and student; deep focus; 90 minutes of planning daily	Year-long content is compressed into a semester, which complicates Advanced Placement and state assessment timing and course sequencing across semesters

The honest summary: the two block schedules deliver the floor at no cost and already exist in Florida, the six-period day delivers it for the price of protecting time teachers are already contracted to spend on campus, and the seven-period day delivers it for real money unless the district reworks its master schedule. The floor treats all four the same. The district picks.

D. Define duty-free

Planning time under the floor may not be assigned to substitute coverage, mandatory meetings, student supervision, or administrative paperwork. This applies equally to a planning period during the student day and to contracted time after it. Emergency coverage remains available at the district's discretion, compensated at a per-period rate set in the bargaining agreement, and every period so used is counted and reported. Closing that loophole costs nothing and is the provision teachers will feel first.

E. Support the transition

Direct the Department of Education to provide technical assistance on master scheduling for each of the four models and to administer a one-time, competitive transition grant for districts that reach the Phase 2 floor early. The grant funds scheduling consulting, one year of transition costs, and the data systems needed to report planning minutes. It does not fund permanent positions. A district that chooses to meet the floor by hiring does so with its own FEFP allocation.

F. Measure it

Require each district to report annually to the Department of Education the planning minutes delivered per teacher by grade band and schedule type, the minutes lost to coverage and reassignment, and the teacher retention rate. Require the Department to publish a statewide

retention target and a district-by-district comparison. What the state does not measure, it cannot hold anyone to.

V. Fiscal Impact Statement

A. Tax or fee issues

None.

B. Government sector impact

Item	Amount	Character
Phase 1 floor (codifies current practice in most districts)	Indeterminate, minimal	Local; absorbed within existing schedules
Department of Education technical assistance and reporting system	\$5 million	Nonrecurring, General Revenue, FY 2027-28
Transition grants (competitive, one-time)	\$25 million	Nonrecurring, General Revenue, FY 2027-28 and FY 2028-29
Phase 2 floor, block-schedule districts	None	Already compliant
Phase 2 floor, six-period districts	Minimal	Local; meetings and duties moved or compensated; no change to teaching load
Phase 2 floor, seven-period districts keeping seven periods	Significant unless the master schedule is redesigned	Local; illustrative math below

The cost driver is the seven-period day. A teacher who moves from six of seven periods to five of seven delivers one-sixth fewer sections. For a high school with 100 teachers, 600 sections at the current load require 120 teachers at the new load if nothing else changes, about 20 additional FTE or roughly \$1.5 million per school at a loaded cost of \$75,000. Statewide, meeting the floor by hiring alone in every seven-period school would cost several hundred million dollars a year and cannot be staffed in the current labor market. That is why the proposal phases the floor, funds transition support, provides a waiver, and treats every schedule equally: a seven-period district that cannot fund the second period can move to a six-period day with protected after-school time, or to a block, and meet the same floor with the same teachers.

Offsetting savings accrue locally. At the Learning Policy Institute's large-district replacement cost of \$24,930, a district that retains 40 additional teachers a year avoids about \$1 million in turnover cost, before the instructional benefit of an experienced teacher remaining in the classroom.

C. Private sector impact

None material. Charter schools are addressed in section VI.D.

VI. Constitutional and Legal Issues

A. Municipality and county mandates restrictions

Article VII, section 18 of the Florida Constitution applies to counties and municipalities. School districts are not within its scope, and the provision is not implicated.

B. Class size

Article IX, section 1 of the Florida Constitution and s. 1003.03, F.S., cap core-course class sizes at 18, 22, and 25 students by grade band. A district may not meet the planning floor by consolidating sections above those caps. Every model in IV.B keeps class sizes constant; the technical assistance program should make that explicit, and the reporting requirement should include class-size compliance so the two mandates are read together.

C. Collective bargaining

Planning time is a term and condition of employment and a mandatory subject of bargaining under chapter 447, F.S., and Article I, section 6 of the Florida Constitution. A statutory minimum does not displace bargaining. It sets a floor below which no agreement may fall, exactly as the state's minimum base salary operates today, and districts and unions remain free to bargain above it, including how contracted after-school time is scheduled and compensated. The Phase 2 effective date is set two full bargaining cycles out for that reason.

D. Charter schools

Section 1002.33(16), F.S., exempts charter schools from chapter 1012 except for enumerated sections. The sponsor must decide whether to add the planning-time floor to that list. This brief recommends applying the reporting requirement to charter schools and leaving the floor optional for them in Phase 1, with the question revisited on the Phase 1 data. Alliance, the network that produced the strongest evidence for this proposal, is a charter network that adopted the five-of-seven load voluntarily.

E. Rulemaking authority

The State Board of Education would need express authority to adopt rules for the waiver process, the definition of duty-free time, and the reporting format under s. 1001.02, F.S.

F. Public records and open meetings

None. District reports are public records, and no exemption is proposed.

VII. Implementation Timeline

When	What happens
July 1, 2027	Act takes effect. Department of Education opens the technical assistance program and issues the reporting format by rule. Districts report baseline planning minutes and schedule type for 2026-27 by October 1, 2027.
2027-28 school year	Phase 1 floor in force: 250 minutes secondary, 225 elementary, duty-free as defined. First round of transition grants awarded. Districts below the floor file plans.
2028 Regular Session	Department reports baseline minutes, minutes lost to coverage, and retention by district and schedule type. Legislature reviews the Phase 2 level against the data and adjusts if warranted.
2028-29 school year	Second round of transition grants. Early-adopter districts add the second planning period, protect the after-school block, or move to a block schedule. Waiver applications due to the State Board by January 1, 2029.
2029-30 school year	Phase 2 floor in force: 450 minutes secondary, 300 elementary, subject to approved waivers.
2031 Regular Session	Three-year retention readout against the published target. Sunset review of the grant program.

VIII. Statutes Affected and Legislative Sequencing

A. Statutes affected

Change	Vehicle
Establish the phased planning-time floor in minutes per week, define duty-free, create the waiver, and require reporting	Amendment to s. 1012.22(1)(h), F.S.
Conform district board rulemaking on planning time	Amendment to s. 1001.42(4)(k), F.S.
Grant State Board rulemaking authority	Amendment to s. 1001.02, F.S., or express authority in the amended section
Decide charter school applicability	Amendment to s. 1002.33(16), F.S.
Create the transition technical assistance and grant program	New section in chapter 1011 or 1012, F.S., with a three-year sunset

Change	Vehicle
Appropriate about \$30 million nonrecurring over two fiscal years	General Appropriations Act, FY 2027-28 and FY 2028-29

B. Sequencing for the 2027 Regular Session

1. **September to October 2026.** Request from the Department of Education whatever planning-time data districts already report, and from the five largest districts their current bargained minutes, schedule type, contracted after-school time, and coverage practices. Confirm with the Department that no 6A rule sets a floor. These establish the Phase 1 baseline and the fiscal note.
2. **October 15, 2026.** Agency legislative budget requests are due under s. 216.023, F.S. If the Department will carry the technical assistance program as an agency request, the appropriation enters the recommended budget with agency support.
3. **November 2026 to February 2027 interim committee weeks** (November 17 to 19, November 30 to December 3, January 4 to 7 and 11 to 14, February 1 to 4, 8 to 11, and 15 to 18). Brief the Senate Committee on Education Pre-K-12 and the House Education and Employment Committee, and the PreK-12 appropriations subcommittees in each chamber. Invite Duval to present its block-school experience and a seven-period district to present its cost estimate for a second planning period.
4. **Bill filing.** File in both chambers before the filing deadline, with a sponsor on each chamber's education committee. Draft the floor as minutes per week, not periods per day, so it applies across every schedule type in the state.
5. **March 2 to April 30, 2027.** Regular Session. Secure the nonrecurring appropriation in the Department of Education line and proviso directing the grant criteria.
6. **July 1, 2027.** Effective date.

C. Anticipated objections

Objection	Response
This is an unfunded mandate on districts.	Phase 1 codifies current practice in the large districts and costs nothing. Phase 2 can be met at no cost on a block schedule, at minimal cost on a six-period day, and with state transition support on a seven-period day, with a waiver for districts that document a constraint. A district that prefers to hire may, with its own allocation.
This forces districts onto a block schedule.	It does not. The floor is minutes per week. A seven-period district adds a second planning period; a six-period district protects the after-school time its teachers are already contracted for. Section IV.C lays out the trade-offs of each schedule and leaves the choice local.

Objection	Response
Planning time is a local bargaining matter.	It remains one. The state sets a floor, as it does for base salary, and every agreement may exceed it.
Districts will cut electives to free the time.	A six-period day has fewer slots than seven, and that is a real trade a district may choose. The reporting requirement will show any district that cuts offerings, and Alliance expanded elective and dual-enrollment access while cutting the teaching load.
Fewer teaching periods means larger classes.	Class size is capped by the Constitution. Every model in IV.B keeps class sizes constant. Consolidation above the caps is unlawful regardless of this proposal.
Florida should spend the money on pay.	The state has raised pay every year since 2020 and average salary still ranks 50th, because raises have gone to the base. Average pay rises when experienced teachers stay. Time is how they stay, and it costs a fraction of a raise.

Florida's teacher shortage is described as a pay problem, and the state's pay investments are real. The state has also already run the pay-only experiment: starting salary rose to 19th in the nation while average salary stayed 50th. Money brought teachers in. Time is what keeps them.

Appendix A: Field Comparison Detail

My Loudoun County schedule was an A/B block: four 90-minute periods per day, alternating days, with three teaching blocks and one planning block daily, about 450 planning minutes per week. Loudoun County's published workday policy (Policy 7030) sets a 7.5-hour contract day and was not retrievable in full for this brief; the schedule described is my direct experience, and the Virginia norm is documented in Virginia Beach Regulation 4-60.1 (250 minutes per week, secondary). Florida figures reflect the Hillsborough, Duval, and Orange agreements cited in section II.C and my conversations with teachers in those and other districts since moving to Florida.

Under nine minutes per section is not enough to grade one assignment, let alone plan the next lesson, so the work goes home. That is the entire distance between a teacher who leaves at 4:00 and one who grades until 11:00, and it is a decision about the schedule, not a personal failing.

Appendix B: Sources

Florida law and budget

- Florida Statutes (2026): ss. 1001.02, 1001.42(4)(k), 1002.33(16), 1003.03, 1012.22(1)(h), and 216.023; chapter 447. flsenate.gov/laws/statutes/2026

- Florida Constitution, Article I, section 6 (collective bargaining); Article VII, section 18 (county and municipal mandates); Article IX, section 1 (class size).
- HB 5001E (2026), General Appropriations Act for FY 2026-27, chapter 2026-232, Laws of Florida; WUSF, "Florida lawmakers pass \$114.5 billion budget, including millions for teacher pay increases," May 29, 2026.
- Florida Senate, 2026-2027 Interim Committee Meeting Schedule (Office of the President).

Salary, vacancy, and workload data

- National Education Association, Rankings and Estimates, April 2026 (Florida average salary \$56,663, rank 50 of 51; starting salary \$49,435, rank 19; national averages \$74,495 and \$48,112; ten-year real decline 12.4 percent). Florida state report via Florida Education Association.
- Florida Education Association, vacancy counts, August 2024 (9,842), August 2025 (5,489), and August 2026 (3,157 instructional; about 5,536 total); WLRN, August 10, 2026; WUSF, August 12, 2026.
- RAND Corporation, State of the American Teacher, 2025 (49 hours per week; about 10 uncompensated; 16 percent intent to leave) and 2026 (18 percent intent to leave).
- OECD, Teaching and Learning International Survey (TALIS) 2024, United States country note, 2025; Education Week, October 14, 2025 (U.S. teachers more than 45 hours per week versus OECD about 40; high stress 30 percent versus 19 percent).
- Learning Policy Institute, teacher turnover cost fact sheet, September 2024 (\$11,860, \$16,450, and \$24,930 by district size); Learning Policy Institute, March 17, 2026 (turnover 8.0 percent for high satisfaction versus 22.0 percent for low).

Schedule models and comparison states

- Education Week, "How These Schools Doubled Teacher Planning Time," May 2026; Education Resource Strategies, Alliance College-Ready Public Schools case study, February 19, 2026 (retention 87 to 91 percent; five-of-seven teaching load; expansion to 11 of 25 schools by 2027-28).
- Hillsborough Classroom Teachers Association, 2023-26 agreement (revised July 1, 2024); Duval Teachers United, 2025-27 agreement; Orange County Classroom Teachers Association, 2024-27 agreement (ratified October 24, 2025).
- Texas Education Code s. 21.404; Tennessee Code s. 49-1-302; Georgia Code s. 20-2-218 and Rule 160-5-1-.02; North Carolina General Statutes s. 115C-301.1; Virginia Code s. 22.1-291.1; Virginia Beach City Public Schools Regulation 4-60.1 (revised March 20, 2024).

Every cost figure in this brief is an illustrative estimate built from the sources above and labeled as such. Before a bill moves, the Department of Education should be asked for district-level planning-minute, schedule-type, and section-count data, and the Legislature's Office of Economic and Demographic Research should review the Phase 2 assumptions.